T3 CONSULTING

Environmentally Conscious Design

Integrated engineering and environmental planning supported the undergrounding of seven miles of 12 kV distribution for a Southern California electric utility, enabling permitting and design to move together and the project to energize seven months ahead of schedule.

CLIENT

Leading Southern California Electric Utility

SERVICES

Engineering & Design · Stakeholder Outreach · Property Owner Liaison

RESULTS

15%

Saved against the program average for engineering and design cost.

7 mo

Ahead of initial energization schedule.

0

Customer-driven design changes during construction.

Early coordination reduced environmental and cultural impacts and supported more effective landowner engagement throughout the alignment.



THE SITUATION

A complex undergrounding project shaped by environmental, cultural, and community constraints

The Strategic Undergrounding Program (SUG) exists to reduce wildfire risk and the impact of Public Safety Power Shutoffs during extreme weather. T3 led the undergrounding of a 7-mile, 12 kV circuit — while protecting natural habitat along the route.

The alignment carried endangered and protected plant and animal species and sensitive Native American cultural sites, and ran through a ranch community with a long local history. That complexity extended beyond the alignment, requiring ongoing coordination with property owners, tribal nations, and local entities.

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OUR APPROACH

Environmental and engineering, decided together.



01 Communication and Collaboration

The project team spanned property owners, multiple infrastructure utilities, tribal stakeholders, and subcontractors. As property owner liaison and outreach lead, T3 built the communication protocols and kept every channel timely and transparent.

02 Environmental Integration

T3 integrated environmental and cultural considerations into the design process from the outset, allowing sensitive habitat, tribal resources, drainage, and jurisdictional waters to inform engineering decisions. Design alternatives were evaluated early, while adjustments could still be made without disrupting the project schedule

03 Stakeholder Alignment

T3 maintained ongoing coordination with property owners, tribal stakeholders, utilities, and other project partners as design and environmental work advanced. Early alignment allowed the team to respond to changing conditions, evaluate alternatives, and resolve issues before construction.

OUTCOME

Earliest customer commitment in the five-year program history

KEY SUCCESSES

01

Accelerated Project Completion

Construction expedited 7 months ahead of schedule — the fastest award-to-construction-and-energization timeline in the program's five-year history. T3 identified the project for expedited completion, directly supporting the utility's energized-miles commitment to the California Public Utilities Commission (CPUC).

02

New Record for Property Owner Coordination

All Permission-to-Enter forms secured before the 30% design-stage job walk, a first in the SUG program. No customer-driven design changes were made during construction.

03

Improved Tribal Relations

Working directly with the tribal nations, T3 avoided disturbance to highly sensitive cultural resources — renewing trust between the utility and the tribes.

> *"The ownership could not be happier with the work performed by T3 Consulting during this project. The crews worked tirelessly to push this project across the finish line while still respecting this beautiful place we all call home."*

RANCH MANAGEMENT

LET'S BUILD IT RIGHT

Talk to a technical professional.

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